One successful run is luck.

Why I rerun everything — and what a single green build actually proves.

10 slides · swipe

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Deploy day always looks like a miracle.

First run: works. Champagne. Ship it. Second run: works — until it doesn't. Because nobody checks whether the success was repeatable or just the first lucky permutation.

One success is an anecdote.
Ten is a system.

The rerun discipline.

01 Run it once — does it work at all?

↓

02 Run it with bad input — does it fail honestly?

↓

03 Run it against a corrupt state — does it recover or poison?

↓

04 Then ship — with logs proving the path

Shipping is the outcome of verification, not the start.

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The 'it worked once' red flags.

01 Untested on clean machines — only on the builder's box

02 A race that passed because the timing was fresh

03 A cache that happened to be warm on first attempt

04 Data that happened to be clean — this time

Fresh luck is the most seductive failure mode.

Why the second run matters more.

The second run catches the stale cache, the already-existing record, the ID collision, the duplicate side effect. Everything the first run silently skipped.

First run shows it works.
Second run shows it won't lie to you.

Two deploy cultures.

LUCKY

Ship on green

one pass = prod
fingers crossed
rollback roulette

ENGINEERED

Ship on evidence

rerun + edge cases
rollback rehearsed
fingers unnecessary

One is hope with a merge button. The other is engineering.

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The habit that ended my on-calls-of-shame.

Before every risky change: rerun the last known good path against the new code. If the past still works and the present does too, the future is allowed in.

Verify yesterday still works.
Then trust today.

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The rerun checklist worth printing.

01 Same input, second time — identical result?

02 Empty input — fails honestly?

03 Half-written state — recovers or refuses?

04 With the network down — degrades, not corrupts?

Four runs. Five minutes. Every deploy. No exceptions.

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The luck law.

If it only works when everything is fresh and perfect, it doesn't work — it merely hasn't failed yet.

Production is never fresh. Production is hostile. Design for both.

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Save this for your next deploy.

Next Friday deploy: run the suite twice before merging. The second pass catches what green paint hides. Save this for the merge button.

Save for later review

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